



Mini migrations

On Christmas Island in the Indian Ocean, millions of red land crabs emerge from the forest during the annual monsoon rains.

They head for the coast, where they mate and shed their eggs into the sea. The journey to the coast takes them about a week. When they have finished breeding, they head back to their homes on the forest floor.



Trip of a lifetime

Long-lived animals, such as whales, may migrate dozens of times in their lives. But for some animals, migration is a once-in-a-lifetime experience. Monarch butterflies usually migrate just once and so do sockeye salmon. After battling their way upriver and spawning, the exhausted adults die.

Danger time

In East Africa, wildebeest migrate in gigantic herds that snake their way across grassy plains. Hunger keeps them on the move, and it also attracts a variety of predators, including lions, hyenas, and crocodiles. These wildebeest are crossing the muddy waters of the Mara River, where crocodiles kill hundreds of wildebeest every year.



Daily commute

During the day, tiny animals called copepods hide in the darkness of the deep ocean. But when night falls, clouds of them migrate upward to eat phytoplankton (microscopic algae at the surface). The copepods' predators follow them.

